# Simulant report

https://www.wikipedia.org/ · run 20261024-065009-c7f3 · 87.9s

**do not ship - Critical user abandonment and multiple high-severity mobile accessibility/usability failures require fixes before release**

| 83 | 63 | 62 | 91 | 100 | 100 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Overall | Usability | Accessibility | Performance | Functional | Integrity |

The site has a critical usability failure causing deal-hunter users to abandon with maximum frustration, and mobile 3G users experience multiple accessibility, performance, and usability issues including being stuck on error pages. The worst problems are the critical drop-off on the homepage, inaccessible icon-only buttons/links, slow 4.5s load times on 3G, and error pages without recovery options. Mobile users on slow connections are most severely impacted, facing compounding barriers across accessibility, performance, and usability.

## Top risks

- Critical user abandonment on homepage (frustration 100/100) for deal-hunter persona
- Mobile 3G users stuck on error pages with no recovery options
- 1741 icon-only buttons/links lack accessible names, blocking screen reader users
- 4.5s page load on 3G exceeds performance thresholds for mobile users

## Simulated users

| Persona | Outcome | Steps | Frustration | Goal / how it ended |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **deal_hunter** | abandoned | 21 | 100/100 | I need to hunt down free info on Wikipedia by searching for "India", then digging up the "Indian Constitution" article, and finally reading about "Mahatma Gandhi" without any donation prompts or tracking tricks.<br>*frustration reached 100/100: could not goto ": off-site navigation is not allowed; confusing screen (Need to get back to Wikipedia main page to find link); could not goto ": off-site navigation is not allowed* |
| **mobile_3g** | failure | 5 | 28/100 | I need to quickly look up India, the Indian Constitution, and Mahatma Gandhi on Wikipedia from my phone while on the train.<br>*Can't go back, stuck on error page, need to restart* |

## Findings (13)

CRITICAL usability measured deal_hunter

### F1 · Drop-off: The Deal-Hunter abandoned the site (frustration 100/100) on /

What frustrated them: could not back ": Page.go_back: net::ERR_FAILED; could not type ": "type" needs "target": <element id>. To fill several fields use {"action":"fill","fields":[{"target":ID,"value":"..."}]}; could not goto ": off-site navigation is not allowed; confusing screen (Need to get back to Wikipedia main page to find link); could not goto ": off-site navigation is not allowed

*“Need to get back to Wikipedia main page to find link”*

Fix: Fix the friction points listed in this finding; they pushed a realistic user to quit.

HIGH accessibility measured mobile_3g

### F2 · Buttons/links with no accessible name (icon-only) (1741)

Examples: a ""; a#mwRw ""; a#mwSw ""

*“Need to search India quickly”*

Fix: Give icon-only controls a visible text label or at least an aria-label.

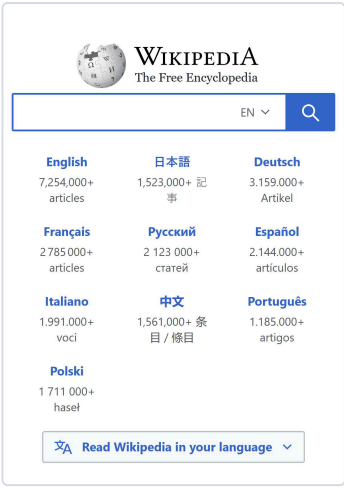



MEDIUM performance measured mobile_3g

### F3 · Slow page load: 4.5s on a slow 3G connection

/ took 4475 ms to finish loading.

Fix: Compress images, defer non-critical scripts and cache static assets.




MEDIUM usability AI-observed mobile_3g

### F4 · Language selection grid dominates viewport on mobile

A large, dense grid of language links pushes primary content down and creates tiny, hard-to-tap targets.

*“Too many languages cluttering the screen. I just want to type my search and go!”*

Fix: Replace the full language grid with a collapsible selector or 'More languages' link to prioritize search.



MEDIUM accessibility measured mobile_3g

### F5 · Images without alt text (19)

Examples: 60px-Emblem_of_India.svg.png?utm_source=en.wikipedia.org&utm_campaign=parser&utm_content=thumbnail; 250px-Battle_at_Lanka%2C_Ramayana%2C_Udaipur%2C_1649-53.jpg?utm_source=en.wikipedia.org&utm_campaign=parser&utm_content=thumbnail; 250px-Cave_26%2C_Ajanta.jpg?utm_source=en.wikipedia.org&utm_campaign=parser&utm_content=thumbnail

*“Need to search India quickly”*

Fix: Add a meaningful alt attribute to every informative image (alt="" for decorative ones).




MEDIUM accessibility measured mobile_3g

### F6 · Low colour contrast text (WCAG AA fails) (2)

Examples: span "medium" ratio 1.9; span "low inequality" ratio 4.2

*“Need to search India quickly”*

Fix: Raise text/background contrast to at least 4.5:1 (3:1 for large text).




MEDIUM accessibility AI-observed mobile_3g

### F7 · Citation reference links are too small to tap

Superscript citation numbers like [20] are tiny and tightly spaced, making accurate tapping nearly impossible.

*“Okay, I've found the page, but there's a lot of text and small links to navigate.”*

Fix: Increase tap target size for citation links to at least 44x44 CSS pixels with adequate spacing.



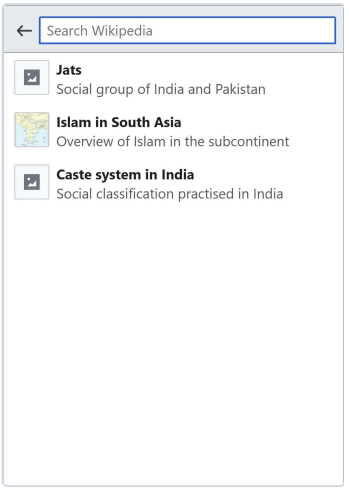
MEDIUM usability AI-observed mobile_3g

### F8 · Search input obscured by overlapping page elements

The search box is visually covered by other UI components, preventing users from locating or using it.

*“Need to search Indian Constitution quickly”*

Fix: Adjust z-index and layout constraints to ensure the search input remains fully visible and unobstructed.




MEDIUM usability AI-observed mobile_3g

### F9 · Error page lacks recovery options and content

The error page displays no content or interactive elements, preventing users from navigating back or retrying.

*“Oops, page blank, need to go back to search”*

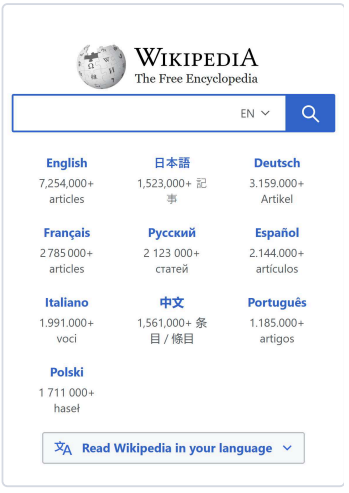
Fix: Add clear error messaging, a functional back link, and a search retry option to the error page.

LOW accessibility measured mobile_3g

### F10 · Tap targets smaller than 32px (7)

Examples: select#searchLanguage "Afrikaans Shqip العربية Asturi"; a "You can support our work with "; a "Download Wikipedia for Android"

Fix: Make touch targets at least 44x44px with spacing between them.



LOW accessibility measured mobile_3g

### F11 · Text smaller than 12px (94)

Examples: span#mwFQ "["; span#mwFA "[1]"; span#mwFg "]"

*“Need to search India quickly”*

Fix: Use at least 14-16px for body text.




LOW usability AI-observed mobile_3g

### F12 · Search button is small and lacks loading feedback

The search submit button has a small hit area and provides no visual indication when a search is processing.

*“Need new search, tap search button then type new query”*

Fix: Enlarge the search button touch target and add a loading spinner or disabled state on submit.




LOW usability AI-observed mobile_3g

### F13 · Dense inline links reduce readability and tap accuracy

Hyperlinks are densely packed within paragraph text, making them hard to distinguish and target individually.

*“Okay, I've found the page, but there's a lot of text and small links to navigate.”*

Fix: Increase line-height and link spacing, or use underlines and padding to improve link affordance and targeting.




## Step-by-step journeys

### deal_hunter — abandoned

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| #1 | click [1] "English 7,254,000+ articles" | page changed after 0.3s, new page | F 0 |
| #2 | goto = '/wiki/India' | FAILED: off-site navigation is not allowed | F 12 |
| #3 | goto = '/' | FAILED: off-site navigation is not allowed | F 24 |
| #4 | back | page changed after 0.3s, new page | F 16 |
| #5 | type [11] "Search Wikipedia" = 'India\n' | page changed after 1.6s, new page | F 8 |
| #6 | scroll | done | F 8 |
| #7 | goto = '/wiki/Constitution_of_India' | FAILED: off-site navigation is not allowed | F 20 |
| #8 | scroll | done | F 20 |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| #9 | goto = '/wiki/Constitution_of_India' | FAILED: off-site navigation is not allowed | F 32 |
| #10 | scroll | done | F 32 |
| #11 | scroll | done | F 32 |
| #12 | click [49] "Constitution of India" | page changed after 0.2s, new page | F 24 |
| #13 | goto = '/en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Constitution_of_India' | FAILED: off-site navigation is not allowed | F 36 |
| #14 | goto = '/wiki/Constitution_of_India' | FAILED: off-site navigation is not allowed | F 48 |
| #15 | goto = '/wiki/Constitution_of_India' | FAILED: off-site navigation is not allowed | F 60 |
| #16 | back | FAILED: Page.go_back: net::ERR_FAILED | F 72 |
| #17 | wait | done | F 72 |
| #18 | wait | done | F 72 |
| #19 | type = 'India\n' | FAILED: "type" needs "target": <element id>. To fill several fields use {"action":"fill","fields":[{"target":ID,"value":"..."}]} | F 84 |
| #20 | goto = '/wiki/Constitution_of_India' | FAILED: off-site navigation is not allowed | F 96 |
| #21 | goto = '/' | FAILED: off-site navigation is not allowed | F 100 |

### mobile_3g — failure

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| #1 | type [11] "Search Wikipedia" = 'India\n' | page changed after 1.6s, new page | F 0 |
| #2 | click [2] "Search" | page changed after 0.2s, new page | F 0 |
| #3 | type [54] "Search Wikipedia" = 'Indian Constitution\n' | page changed after 0.2s, new page | F 0 |
| #4 | back | FAILED: Page.go_back: net::ERR_FAILED | F 19 |

Severity: measured = deterministic browser checks; rule check = business-rule oracle; AI-observed = vision/LLM opinion (capped at medium unless several personas agree).